

THE POPE IN ROME

In Leonardo's time, the pope lived at the Vatican in Rome, the headquarters of the Catholic Church, as he still does today. In addition to being the religious leader of the Church, the pope controlled vast areas of land in Italy, known as the Papal States. Some popes also became military leaders and tried to expand the territories they already possessed.

This portrait of a seated Pope Leo X is by Raphael. The figure on the left is Giulio di Giuliano de Medici.

